

Dalton Kutzen

Curriculum Vitae

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Education

Brigham Young University — B.S. Molecular Biology
Provo, Utah

Jan 2025 – Apr 2028

Experience

Bioinformatics Researcher

Aug 2026 – Present

[Terooatea Lab, Brigham Young University](#) · Provo, UT

- Developed computational methods and benchmark evaluations for high-dimensional single-cell RNA-seq (scRNA-seq) and pooled Perturb-seq screens (anchor-op).
- Implemented target-grouped nested cross-validation and matched signal-to-noise ratio (SNR) controls in Python to evaluate prediction performance against baseline models.
- Co-authored bioRxiv research on perturbation screen modeling and computational reproducibility.

Research Assistant

Sep 2025 – Present

[Grose Lab, Brigham Young University](#) · Provo, UT

- Prepared media, cultured bacteriophages with bacterial hosts, and conducted plaque and spot assays to evaluate phage activity and host interactions.
- Performed bioinformatic analyses to annotate and compare phage genomes, creating the **Phantom** Snakemake pipeline for reproducible annotation.
- Integrated wet lab microbiology techniques with computational genomics to investigate phage diversity, host range, and therapeutic applications.

IT Service Desk Supervisor

May 2026 – Present

[Brigham Young University — College of Life Sciences](#) · Provo, UT

- Lead frontline IT support for faculty, staff, and students across the College of Life Sciences, resolving high-complexity hardware, software, and systems incidents.
- Mentor student technicians in troubleshooting best practices and train new hires on Life Sciences IT infrastructure, tools, and clear user communication.
- Drove internal automation, documentation, and reporting initiatives that reduced repetitive workflows and standardized support delivery college-wide.

IT Service Desk Technician

Aug 2025 – May 2026

[Brigham Young University](#) · Provo, UT

- Oversaw deployment, security, and maintenance of 1,000+ campus workstations and lab computers, minimizing system downtime.
- Supported a community of 5,000+ users by troubleshooting hardware, software, and wireless networking issues for academic and administrative operations.

Publications & Preprints

- Fullmer, K. J., **Kutzen, D.**, & Terooatea, T. W. (2026). Additive-input encoding fails operator-level target-held-out prediction on current Perturb-seq screens. *bioRxiv*. [[anchor-op](#)]

Presentations & Posters

- **Kutzen, D.** (Spring 2026). *Phages*. Poster Presentation, American Society for Microbiology, Intermountain Branch Conference, Salt Lake City, UT.

Selected Projects

Phantom — Bacteriophage Analysis Workflow

Jun 2026 – Present

- Modular Snakemake pipeline for phage genome annotation and downstream comparative analysis.
- Uses isolated Conda environments and declarative workflow rules to make runs reproducible across systems.
- Produces organized intermediate files, results, logs, and publication-oriented visualizations.

Self-Hosted Systems and Infrastructure

Dec 2025 - Present

- Built a Linux-based environment for code hosting, containers, services, and research project organization.
- Applied infrastructure-as-code and documentation practices to reduce configuration drift.

Technical Skills

Area	Tools & Proficiencies
Computational Biology	Comparative genomics, Snakemake, Conda, Biopython
Wet Lab & Molecular Biology	Phage and bacterial culturing, plaque & spot assays, host range testing, media preparation, agarose gel electrophoresis
Programming & Data	Python, R, Bash, SQL, Git, pandas, tidyverse, ggplot2, Quarto
IT & Systems Infrastructure	IT Service Management (ITSM), Linux server administration, Proxmox, Docker, 1,000+ endpoint management, networking
Operations & Leadership	project management, technical mentoring, documentation

Leadership & Service

Initiative Lead

Jan 2026 – Present

Leadership and the Scriptures, Brigham Young University · Provo, UT

- Plan and facilitate structured discussions connecting scriptural principles with practical leadership in academic, community, and professional settings.
- Guide participants in developing actionable leadership habits centered on empathy, honoring agency, and fostering personal and interpersonal accountability.

Counselor and Youth Mentor

May 2025 – Aug 2025

FSY Conferences · United States

- Mentored cohorts of 15–25 youth participants, facilitating daily meetings, leadership workshops, and goal-setting activities.
- Motivated participants to establish actionable personal and academic goals, develop effective study habits, and strengthen character traits.
- Reported regularly to conference leadership regarding participant progress, group dynamics, and logistical improvements.

Full-Time Volunteer

Mar 2022 – Mar 2024

The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints · Wichita, Kansas

- Supervised and trained 200+ volunteers throughout the state of Kansas, enhancing operational productivity and organizational goal execution.
- Provided daily instruction, counseling, and community service to individuals and families to support personal well-being and life skills.

Honors & Awards

- **Scholarship**, Sacramento Alumni Association - Brigham Young University Winter 2027
- **Experiential Learning Grant**, Department of Micro and Molecular Biology - Brigham Young University Fall 2026
- **William Bartlett Hebard Scholarship**, College of Life Sciences - Brigham Young University Fall 2026
- **Experiential Learning Grant**, Department of Micro and Molecular Biology - Brigham Young University Spring 2026